

How big are global ube exports, really?

A practical investor-grade read of official trade codes, Philippine export signals, product forms and exporter countries.

The answer is not a single number. Ube has to be triangulated from Philippine DTI data, adjacent HS codes and shipment/product evidence.

\$3.06M

reported Philippine ube + ube-based
exports in 2025

Not the same thing as global ube
exports.

True ube exports are still small; adjacent yam and powder trade is much larger.

This is a supply-chain professionalization opportunity, not a mature commodity-export category.

\$3.06M

Philippine true-ube public figure

DTI-reported ube and ube-based exports, 2025.

\$104M

Adjacent yam trade

HS 071430 global yams exports, 2024. Not ube-specific.

\$134M

Adjacent powder trade

HS 110620 root/tuber flour exports, 2024. Mostly not ube.

\$8-25M

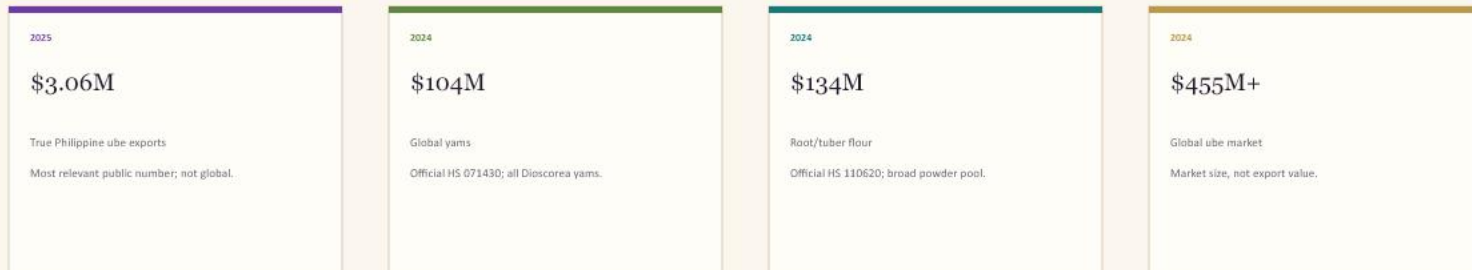
Best true-ube working range

Directional estimate only; requires paid shipment-level validation.

Investor-safe wording: global ube demand is rising faster than verified Philippine-origin supply. Do not claim global ube exports are already huge unless line-level customs data proves it.

The market has four different numbers; only one is true-ube-specific.

Each layer answers a different question. Mixing them creates investor diligence risk.



Use the US\$3.06M figure for actual Philippine ube exports. Use the US\$104M and US\$134M figures only as adjacent trade pools that show where export demand could professionalize.

Customs data does not isolate ube, so product-form shares cannot be read directly.

A real market model must map product descriptions across several HS buckets.

Product form	Likely code	What gets mixed in	How to use it
Fresh/frozen/dried yam	071430	All Dioscorea yams, not just ube	Adjacent root trade
Ube powder / yam flour	110620 / 071430	Cassava, sago, sweet potato, other tuber flours	Powder opportunity proxy
Halaya / jam / spread	200799 / 200899 / 071430	Broad fruit/veg preparations	Shipment-level search
Extract / flavor	210690 / 330210	Food prep and flavor bases	Only directional
Bakery / desserts	1905 / 2105	Finished food where ube is only one ingredient	Demand signal, not ingredient export

Implication: the correct deck language is 'true ube exports are under-reported across broad trade codes,' not 'global exports equal the whole ube market.'

The best public true-ube anchor is the Philippines: US\$3.06M in 2025.

That is small in absolute terms, but strong as an early-stage premium-origin signal.

Ube + ube-based exports, 2025



DTI-reported export value.

Reported export volume signal



Reported in 2026 coverage citing DTI/CNN; product mix not disclosed.

Known destination signals

- United States
- United Kingdom
- Italy
- Middle East
- Japan / Europe case shipments

Most important missing data: DTI has not publicly split the US\$3.06M by powder, puree, halaya, extract, frozen/grated ube or finished foods.

Official yam exports are about US\$104M, but the leaders are not necessarily ube leaders.

HS 071430 captures Dioscorea yams broadly, including Caribbean, African, Chinese and other yams.

Jamaica



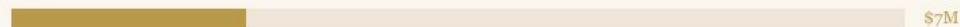
25.5% of visible global HS 071430 export value.

China



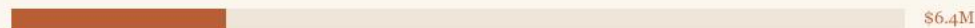
16.5% of visible global HS 071430 export value.

Colombia



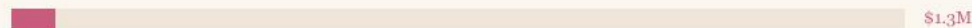
6.7% of visible global HS 071430 export value.

Brazil



6.1% of visible global HS 071430 export value.

France



1.2% of visible global HS 071430 export value.

Do not call this 'global ube exports.'
It is the official adjacent root category that proves there is an international yam trade infrastructure.

Root/tuber flour exports are larger than yam exports, but mostly not ube.

HS 110620 is the closest powder proxy for ube powder, and it reached about US\$134.4M in 2024.

Exporter	Value	Volume	Share	Interpretation
Peru	\$25.56M	3,408 MT	19.0%	High-value specialty root/tuber flour signal.
Thailand	\$25.54M	47,141 MT	19.0%	Large-volume cassava/tapioca-adjacent processing base.
United States	\$11.44M	6,788 MT	8.5%	Re-export / specialty ingredient trade.
Brazil	\$10.86M	9,113 MT	8.1%	Root crop processing and regional trade.
Netherlands	\$7.69M	2,480 MT	5.7%	European trading and redistribution hub.
Nicaragua	\$7.47M	5,696 MT	5.6%	Root/tuber flour exporter.
EU	\$7.00M	3,404 MT	5.2%	Reported bloc activity.
China	\$6.50M	1,995 MT	4.8%	Asian processed-root exporter.

Philippines reported only about US\$98k under HS 110620 in 2024, which proves ube powder is likely being coded elsewhere or is still very underdeveloped.

Current ube exports are probably heavier in frozen/paste/jam, while powder wins strategic value.

No official product-form split is public, so this is an evidence-weighted interpretation.

Form	Likely current share	Confidence	Why	Strategic attractiveness
Frozen / grated / puree / paste	High by volume	Medium	Heavier products already move through Filipino grocery and foodservice channels.	High
Powder / flour	High by value; early	Medium	Shelf-stable, B2B-friendly, easier to sample, test and standardize.	Very high
Halaya / jam / spread	Meaningful	Medium	Visible in sample shipment records; more retail/ethnic-channel and heavier due sugar/water.	Medium
Extract / flavor	Small niche	Low-medium	Demand exists, but codes are broad and many products are not pure ube.	Medium
Fresh whole ube	Low	Medium-high	Bulky, perishable and exposed to phytosanitary/cold-chain friction.	Low
Ube VCO	Tiny / unproven	High	Coconut oil exports are large, but ube-VCO is not a proven ube export category.	Low

The biggest current form is not necessarily the best flagship.

Volume, value and strategic leverage point to different product priorities.

Likely current Philippine export volume

Heavy processed forms lead

1. Frozen / grated / puree / paste
2. Halaya / jam / spread
3. Powder
4. Extract / flavor
5. Fresh whole ube

Best export business attractiveness

Powder should lead

1. Ube powder
2. Frozen puree / grated ube
3. Foodservice ube base / paste
4. Halaya / jam / spread
5. Extract / flavor concentrate
6. Fresh ube
7. Ube VCO

For Vera: use raw trading and frozen/paste relationships to learn supply, but build the investor story around export-grade powder.

There are three different exporter maps, depending on what 'ube' means.

The Philippines is the authenticity leader, not currently the volume leader.

Official yams | HS 071430

Jamaica + China lead

Top visible exporters include Jamaica, China, Colombia, Brazil and France. This is yam trade, not ube-specific.

Root/tuber powders | HS 110620

Peru + Thailand lead

Top exporters include Peru, Thailand, US, Brazil, Netherlands, Nicaragua, EU and China. Mostly not ube.

Purple-yam shipment signals

China + Vietnam show volume

Public shipment databases indicate China and Vietnam appear strong in visible purple-yam shipments; Philippines is smaller but premium-authentic.

Strategic read: Vera should not compete as the cheapest purple-root supplier. It should compete as verified Philippine-origin ube with supply documentation.

Even real Philippine ube products appear under multiple HS codes.

This is why form-share estimates require line-level shipment classification.

Sample product description	Example destination	Code shown	What it tells us
Jonas Purple Yam Ube Spread	Canada	07143010	Prepared spread can still be declared under a yam code.
Buenas Grated Purple Yam	Kuwait	07143010	Grated/frozen forms may remain in yam bucket.
Giron Purple Yam Powder	USA	07143010	Powder may not always appear under flour code.
Purple Yam Jam	USA	20089940	Jam can move to broad prepared-food categories.
Kapuso Grated Purple Yam	New Zealand	07143010	Form split is hidden without descriptions.

To answer product share precisely, buy/export a customs extract and classify descriptions manually into powder, puree/grated, halaya/jam, extract and finished-food buckets.

The opportunity is to organize a premium Philippine supply chain before larger players do.

Do not overclaim the market. Out-execute the messy data.

1

Learn supply through local raw trading

Track price, quality, seasonality, shrinkage and farmer reliability.

2

Build frozen/grated/puree relationships

These forms likely already move; use them as processor and buyer bridges.

3

Launch powder as flagship

Best shelf-stable B2B format for samples, specs, COAs and repeat formulation.

4

Add foodservice base/paste

Use buyer feedback to create a thicker *cafe/bakery/ice-cream* product.

5

Keep VCO, halaya and extracts later

Use only when there is channel proof or a specific buyer request.

Investor line: we are not creating the ube trend; we are converting fragmented Philippine ube into a verified export ingredient platform.

The next diligence step is a paid shipment-level extract, not another market-size report.

This is how to turn the current estimate into a defensible investor appendix.

Data pull	Search terms	Fields needed	Decision it supports
Philippines exports	ube, purple yam, Dioscorea alata	Exporter, buyer, HS, value, kg, product description	True Philippine product-form mix
Global purple yam	purple yam, yam powder, ube powder	Origin, destination, values, weight, importer	Top real exporter countries
Powder codes	110620 + descriptions	Product text and ingredient terms	How much powder is actually ube
Prepared products	halaya, jam, spread, grated, puree	Brand/exporter/destination/channel	Retail vs B2B opportunity split
Buyer universe	importers, cafes, ingredient buyers	Repeat buyers, order size, reorders	Where Vera should sample first

Use this extract to create a real product-share chart. Until then, present form shares as 'best current interpretation,' not as official fact.

Research notes and disclosure language

Use these as the source spine for any investor or partner conversation.

- DTI via BusinessMirror / Xinhua: Philippine ube + ube-based exports reached about US\$3.06M in 2025.
- Rolling Stone Philippines / CNN discussion: almost 1.7M kg of ube products exported, citing DTI/CNN reporting.
- ABRAMS / UN Comtrade summary: HS 071430 yams exports about US\$104.23M in 2024.
- WITS / World Bank Comtrade: HS 110620 root/tuber flour exports about US\$134.4M in 2024.
- Exim sample records: Philippine purple yam products appear as spread, grated yam, powder and jam under multiple codes.
- Volza / Tridge: directional shipment and transaction signals for purple yam / dried yam exporters and prices.
- Disclosure: no official global HS code isolates ube. Product-form shares require line-level shipment classification.

Recommended investor phrasing: "Global ube demand is rising faster than verified Philippine-origin supply. The investable gap is traceable, export-grade supply."